Saturday, November 14, 2026 · Vol. I · No. 39 · DRAM · NAND · HBM · Tel Aviv edition · Data as of ~08:20 IST · US: Friday closes · No Korea session (Friday close in No. 38) · Spot: TrendForce Nov 13 18:10 GMT+8

The Memory Cycle Journal

US FRIDAY — A SECOND DAY OF SELLING

SOX −3.43% 10,146.32; Micron $778.31 −2.52% · Sandisk $885.01 −5.59% · Nvidia $162.85 −2.01% · AMD −8.75% · Yahoo Finance, Reuters

THE WEEK · DRAM SPOT

Micron +12.8% on the week; SOX +8.1%, Nvidia −12.7% · DDR5 16Gb $60.27 (+0.06%) · DDR4 16Gb $79.50 (−0.31%) · Yahoo Finance, TrendForce

LEAD STORY

MARKETS · NVIDIA · HBM

Chip Stocks Slide Again on AI-Financing Fears, but Korea Says Its HBM Is Already Spoken For

The SOX fell 3.4% on Friday as investors weighed Nvidia's role as a financier of the AI build-out without Jensen Huang. Sandisk lost 5.6% and Micron 2.5%. In Seoul, analysts and industry officials argue that long-term contracts cover the next two years and that a wider customer base could strengthen memory makers' hand.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:20 IST Saturday (UTC+2) · US = Friday close · Spot TrendForce Nov 13 18:10 GMT+8 · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · US FRIDAY CLOSE · WEEK · SPOT FRIDAY

US, FRIDAY CLOSE		WEEK AND SPOT	
Micron	**$778.31 (−2.52%)**	Micron, week	**+12.8%**
Sandisk	**$885.01 (−5.59%)**	SOX, week	**+8.1%**
SK hynix ADR	**$131.79 (−4.30%)**	Nvidia, week	**−12.7%**
SOX	**10,146.32 (−3.43%)**	WDC / Seagate	**−5.00% / −3.09%**
Nvidia	**$162.85 (−2.01%)**	DDR5 16Gb spot	**$60.27 (+0.06%)**
Applied Materials	**$370.50 (−2.74%)**	DDR4 16Gb spot	**$79.50 (−0.31%)**

What this shows: rivals that rallied on Thursday gave it back on Friday (AMD −8.75%, Broadcom −4.76%), while memory still ended a volatile week higher. DDR5 spot ticked up after three flat sessions; DDR4 kept easing (16Gb eTT −0.96%). NAND wafer spot ($16.15) is still the Nov 2 print. Weekly changes are desk arithmetic from Friday-to-Friday closes. Sources: Yahoo Finance, Reuters via Investing.com, TrendForce.

Shares of AI-related companies fell again on Friday, with neoclouds hit hardest, as investors worried about financing after Huang's exit, Reuters reported. "It's a short-term death blow to the industry because the amount of vendor financing and financing guarantees that Nvidia and Jensen Huang stepped into are now over," said Thomas Hayes of Great Hill Capital. Nebius closed down 9.9%, CoreWeave 6.1% and Dell 7.2%; Western Digital fell 5.0%. The FT reported that Nvidia's board had approached Arm CEO Rene Haas about the job REPORTED; CNBC said the board has not yet picked a search firm. Over the week, the SOX still rose 8.1% and Micron 12.8%, while Nvidia fell 12.7%.

Korean coverage stressed that existing contracts are intact. SK hynix has said its DRAM and HBM capacity is effectively sold out through 2029, with long-term agreements (LTAs) with 14 major customers; Samsung says its 2027 HBM capacity is fully booked (Korea JoongAng Daily). Daishin Securities estimates SK hynix supplies 55% of Nvidia's HBM4 this year, Samsung 28% and Micron 17%.

"A more diversified customer base could actually strengthen memory suppliers' bargaining power," Mirae Asset's Kim Young-gun wrote. The risk is further out: LTAs could be revised if Nvidia's schedules change from 2027, and Korean press says SK hynix could face more pricing pressure while Samsung gains from a broader customer mix (via TrendForce).

Our call: late upcycle; tight through 2027 / into 2028. Unchanged overall: contracts and prices steady, sentiment looser on AI financing. CYCLE SIGNAL: FUNDAMENTALS STEADY, MULTIPLES UNDER PRESSURE

HBM · FORECASTS

Hana Sees 2027 HBM Demand About 10% Above Supply, With Samsung Taking the Revenue Lead

Hana Securities forecasts 2027 HBM shipments from the three makers at 4.9 billion GB: SK hynix 2.3 billion (47%), Samsung 2.0 billion (41%) and Micron 0.6 billion (12%), Korea Economic TV reported on Nov 13. It expects Samsung to lead on revenue because its HBM4 for Nvidia's Rubin, built on 1c DRAM with a 4nm base die, carries a higher price, while SK hynix's large LTA volumes limit its price increases. Monthly HBM wafer capacity rises from 200k to 260k at SK hynix, 190k to 260k at Samsung and 60k to 80k at Micron. Demand from accelerators (Nvidia 8.96 million GPUs, Google 8.80 million TPUs, AMD 0.97 million, Meta and Amazon ASICs above 4 million) adds up to about 5.5 billion GB. An industry official put the balance after the second half of 2028. Hana cut its targets to ₩400,000 for Samsung and ₩2.8 million for SK hynix on sector de-rating (Newspim).

LEGAL · DRAM

Memory Makers Tell a US Judge the Price Spike Came From AI Demand, Not a Conspiracy

Lawyers for SK hynix, Samsung and Micron argued in San Jose on Friday that a US lawsuit accusing them of restricting supply and fixing DRAM prices describes "lawful oligopoly conduct," MLex reported; their case is that the AI boom, not a conspiracy, moved the market. Judge Noël Wise took the motion to dismiss under submission; a written ruling will follow. Separately, TrendForce said Nvidia's supply chain had shown no significant order cuts so far, though it expects AMD and in-house ASIC servers to gain share in 2027.

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE FRI ~08:30 IST · READ-ONLY

NEW **Applied sees into 2029.** 2027 equipment spending guided up at least 30%, led by leading-edge logic and DRAM. Fab trackers, record utilization and a lack of cleanroom space give visibility into 2029; system output is to double by FY28. Supply-chain pinch points modestly hurt the January-quarter guide. Target cut on sector de-rating, not numbers. Cantor (Nov 13)

POLICY **Tool controls back on the table.** Huang's troubles appear to be hardening Washington's view on China, making the MATCH Act more likely; lawmakers may attach chip bills to the year-end defense bill. Passed as drafted, the broker puts the hit at about 15% of ASML revenue. Jefferies European semis (Nov 13)

FINANCING **Less help from Nvidia.** Interim CEO Kress is expected to offer customers less financial support (The Information), and Bloomberg reports the $500bn bank-financing plan has no deals yet, both relayed by the Jefferies desk. Jefferies sales desk (Nov 13)

ON X · SINCE FRI ~08:30 · IST

@pequityresearch · Nov 13 22:41
Relays KSIA's Ahn: Huang's exit could give memory makers more leverage. "To change suppliers, Nvidia needs alternatives. But where are those alternatives?"
x.com/.../2121342588070363514

@SKundojjala · Nov 13 12:58
Applied Materials: advanced packaging to grow 90% in 2026, mostly HBM; leading-edge logic, DRAM and packaging ~75% of WFE growth through 2030.
x.com/.../2121196056964935876

@trendforce · Nov 13 16:03
OCP 2026: SK hynix (MARS, HBF) and Solidigm (shared SSD KV-cache pool) push AI memory beyond a single HBM tier.
x.com/.../2121242504339087812

@aleabitoreddit · Nov 13 22:25
Quotes an unnamed Korean memory executive: "Thirty people are already lined up at a restaurant that is full, and five of them leaving does not create a table." OPINION
x.com/.../2121338681571328368

@JJoonWick · Nov 13 11:51
SK Securities forward P/E: Samsung 3.3×, SK hynix 2.7×; Micron 4.6× and CXMT 10.6× (estimate bases differ).
x.com/.../2121179247452852311

@GavinSBaker · Nov 14 02:34
Atreides sent a letter to Nvidia's board; he also backs a petition to reinstate Huang. OPINION
x.com/.../2121401397346521412

CYCLE TRACKER · FUNDAMENTALS STEADY; SENTIMENT LOOSER ON AI FINANCING

GAUGE	TODAY VS NOV 13 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	No new contract data. Enterprise DRAM/SSD hikes still verbal; PC DRAM 4Q26 +13–18%, eSSD +15–20% (TrendForce)	**Rising, unchanged**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $60.267 (+0.06%), first uptick after three flat sessions; DDR4 16Gb $79.50 (−0.31%), eTT −0.96%. NAND wafer print still Nov 2	**Flat / DDR4 easing**
Inventory / demand	LTAs intact: SK hynix sold out through 2029, Samsung 2027 HBM booked. Hana: 2027 HBM demand ~10% above supply. Nvidia financing pullback feared (neoclouds −6–10%)	**Amber, steady**
Supply growth / capex	AMAT: visibility into 2029, cleanroom-gated. MATCH Act odds up (tool curbs on China). Hana: HBM wafer capacity +30% at SK hynix and +37% at Samsung in 2027	**Tight, unchanged**
Valuation	SOX −3.43%, MU −2.52%, SNDK −5.59% Friday, but MU +12.8% on the week. SK hynix at 2.7× forward P/E (SK Securities)	**Volatile**

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 38, NOV 13)
Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and into 2028. Unchanged overall. Fundamentals are steady: LTAs hold, Hana sees 2027 HBM demand about 10% above supply with balance only after 2H28, and DDR5 spot ticked up. Sentiment is looser: a second day of AI-hardware selling priced the loss of Nvidia's vendor financing, which is a demand-quality risk for 2028 rather than a 2027 volume risk. Policy is a touch tighter for China supply (MATCH Act). Top playbook signal (DDR5 spot falling while contract rises) has not appeared.

EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 14–DEC 3 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

Tue Nov 17	Nvidia FQ3, first under interim CEO Kress (release ~23:20, call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 Nov 17–19	HBM
Nov 18–20	Anthropic IPO pricing (18th), Nasdaq debut (19th) · Trump at APEC Shenzhen (18–19) · Modine analyst day (18th) · Sandisk split-adjusted trading from Nov 20	Demand
Nov 23–26	Korea Nov 1–20 exports (~23rd) · US PCE (25th) · US markets closed for Thanksgiving (26th); Huang testimony reported due before then	Exports

Nov 30–Dec 3	TrendForce month-end contract prices · House interviews of Huang (Dec 1) and Nvidia's general counsel (Dec 2); Commerce export-control hearing (Dec 3)	Policy
Pending	Ruling on the DRAM price-fixing motion to dismiss (no date) · Samsung–Modine talks (unconfirmed) · NDAA chip-bill attachments	Legal

The Memory Cycle Journal · independent research digest · not investment advice ·
Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #39 · Nov 14, 2026